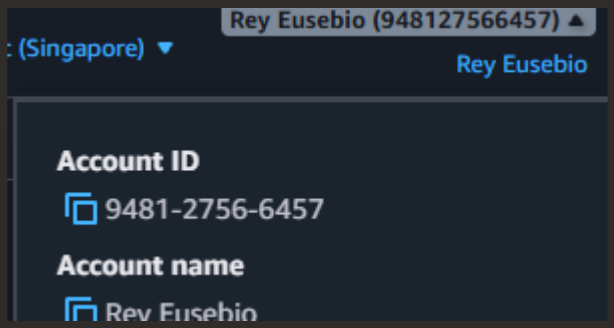
SET UP AN AWS ACCOUNT

By Reynaldo Eusebio | September 2026



Introducing Today's Project!

In this project, I'm going to set up my own AWS account, configure billing and payment information, and enable Free Tier alerts to help prevent unexpected charges. I'll also learn the basics of AWS account security and prepare my account for future cloud projects.

Key tools and concepts

The key tools I used include the AWS Management Console, Billing and Cost Management, and an authenticator app. Key concepts I learnt include AWS Free Tier, billing alerts, root users, identity verification, support plans, and multi-factor authentication (MFA).

Challenges and wins

This project took me approximately 10 minutes. The most challenging part was setting up my AWS account and completing the identity verification and billing steps.

Creating My AWS Account

In this step, I'm going to create my own AWS account so I can start building and learning cloud projects in AWS.

Understanding the root user

I learned that a root user is the main account owner with full access to everything in an AWS account, like a master key to a building. A strong password is important because it helps protect the root user from unauthorized access.

Setting Up Billing and Payment

In this step, I'm going to set up billing and payment information for my AWS account so it is ready to use.

Why AWS requires a payment method

I learned that AWS requires a payment method because it helps verify that I am a real person and gives AWS a way to charge for any usage that goes beyond the Free Tier limits.

Completing Account Activation

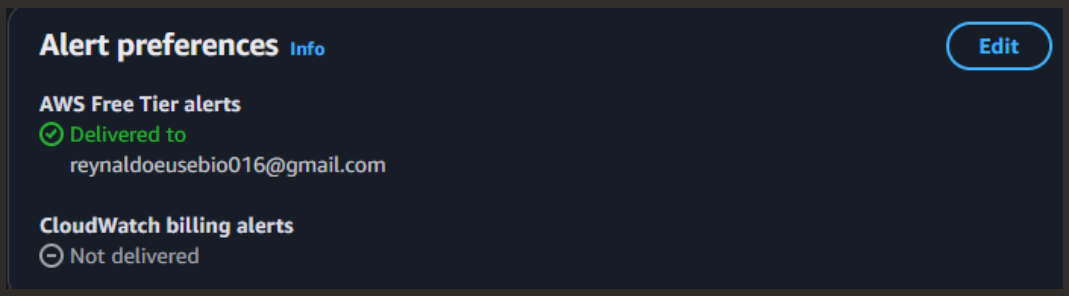
In this step, I'm going to verify my identity and select a support plan to activate my AWS account.

Identity verification and support plan

I verified my identity by entering my phone number and the verification code I received by SMS. The Basic support plan includes access to AWS documentation, forums, and AWS Health checks.

Enabling Free Tier Alerts

In this step, I'm going to enable Free Tier alerts so I can receive an email when my AWS usage gets close to the Free Tier limits.



Why usage alerts matter

I set up usage alerts because they can notify me when my AWS usage gets close to the Free Tier limits and help prevent unexpected charges.

Securing the Account with MFA

To enable MFA, I set up a virtual authenticator app and used it to secure my root account. The authenticator app works by generating a verification code that I use along with my password when signing in.

